

Chapter 2 — Sounding Out Proper Names

Hebrew Vowels — Identification in Proper Names

For each proper name, list every vowel sign you see in left-to-right order by its BBH name (e.g., Qamets, Hireq, Shewa). Then indicate whether any vowel letters (matres lectionis — waw, yod, or he functioning as vowel holders) are present. Note: distinguishing vocal from silent shewa is covered in Chapter 3.

#	Hebrew Name	English Name	Vowels (in Order)	Matres Lectionis?
1	שָׂרָה			
✓	שָׂרָה	Sarah	Qamets, Qamets He	Yes — he (Qamets He)
2	נֹחַ			
✓	נֹחַ	Noah	Holem, Pathach	No
3	דָּוִד			
✓	דָּוִד	David	Qamets, Hireq	No (waw is a consonant)
4	רוּת			
✓	רוּת	Ruth	Shureq	Yes — waw (Shureq)
5	לֵאָה			
✓	לֵאָה	Leah	Tsere, Qamets He	Yes — he (Qamets He)
6	מֹשֶׁה			
✓	מֹשֶׁה	Moses	Holem, Seghol He	Yes — he (Seghol He)
7	יַעֲקֹב			
✓	יַעֲקֹב	Jacob	Pathach, Hateph Pathach, Holem	No
8	יִצְחָק			
✓	יִצְחָק	Isaac	Hireq, Shewa, Qamets	No
9	אַהֲרֹן			
✓	אַהֲרֹן	Aaron	Pathach, Hateph Pathach, Holem	No
10	מִרְיָם			
✓	מִרְיָם	Miriam	Hireq, Shewa, Qamets	No (yod is a consonant)
11	שְׁלֹמֹה			
✓	שְׁלֹמֹה	Solomon	Shewa, Holem, Holem He	Yes — he (Holem He)
12	אֵלִיָּהוּ			
✓	אֵלִיָּהוּ	Elijah	Hateph Seghol, Hireq, Qamets, Shureq	Yes — waw (Shureq)
13	יוֹסֵף			
✓	יוֹסֵף	Joseph	Holem Waw, Tsere	Yes — waw (Holem Waw)
14	אַבְרָהָם			
✓	אַבְרָהָם	Abraham	Pathach, Shewa, Qamets, Qamets	No
15	יְרוּשָׁלַיִם			
✓	יְרוּשָׁלַיִם	Jerusalem	Shewa, Shureq, Qamets, Pathach, Hireq	Yes — waw (Shureq)